Over 50

Left Hand Patterns

for the church pianist

Amanda Tero



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How to use this book

- Each left hand pattern is in the key of C (chords C, F, G)
- You will need to transpose the chords to fit into hymns of different keys (e.g. for the key of F, use the same pattern transposed to F, B-flat, C).
- The patterns are given for entire measures of the same chord (e.g. four beats of C, three beats of C). If you are playing a hymn where the chord changes in fewer beats (e.g. two beats), adapt the left hand pattern accordingly. Sometimes you can omit the last half of the measure and it fits well. Always match the correct rhythm of the hymn.
- Not every style of left hand pattern will fit with every hymn. It may take some experimentation to find the best left hand pattern for a particular hymn.
- These left hand patterns are intended to provide you with ideas to experiment with on your own. You do not have to stick to exactly what's written.
- Mix and match the patterns. Variety is the best seasoning for hymn-playing, so use more than one left hand pattern per hymn.
- You can adapt these patterns to fit other meters.

Practice tips

Learning new styles can be challenging. If you're not able to adapt quickly, here are some practice tips to help you best use these ideas.

- Practice one left hand pattern in every single key using the root (1), sub-dominant (4), and dominant (5) chords of every key
- Choose one left hand pattern and apply it to 3-5 different hymns. Here is a list of ideas:
    - Nothing But the Blood
    - Joy to the World
    - Near the Cross
    - When I Survey the Wondrous Cross
    - When We All Get to Heaven
    - God is so Good
- Once you are comfortable with several left hand patterns, intentionally mix up the patterns in a hymn. There is no right or wrong solution. Just follow your ear.

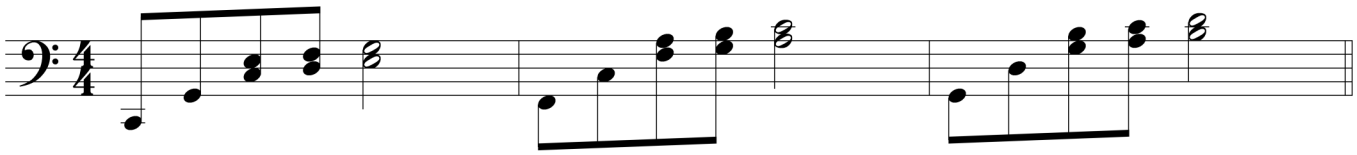
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Left Hand Patterns in $\frac{4}{4}$

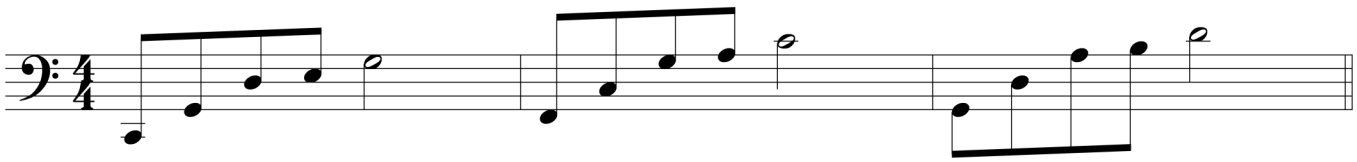


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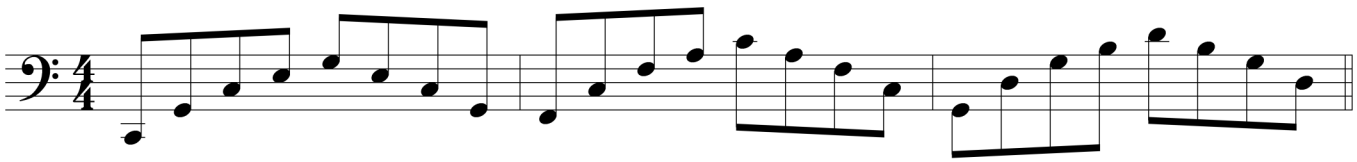
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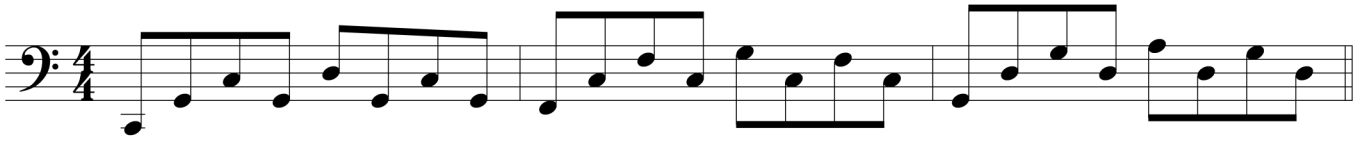
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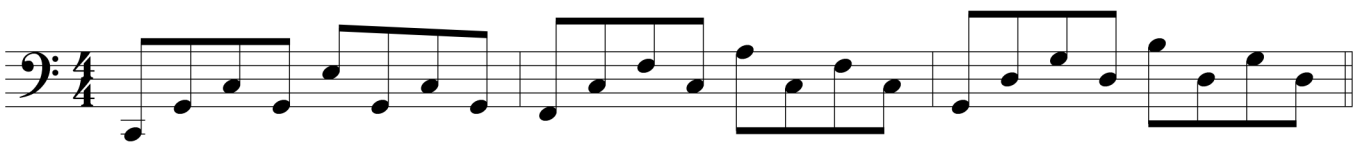
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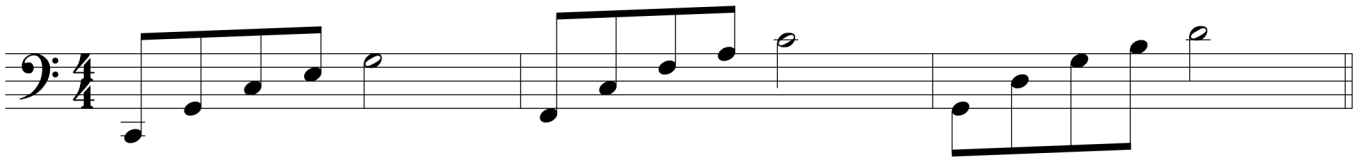
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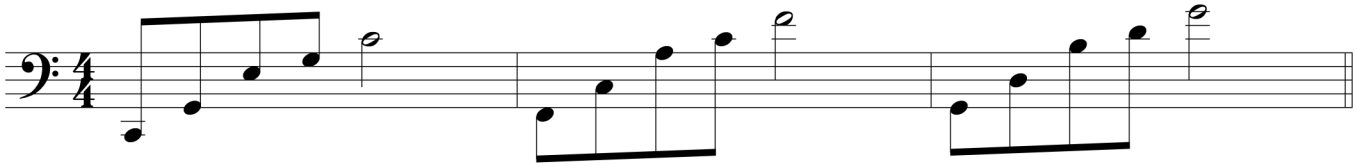
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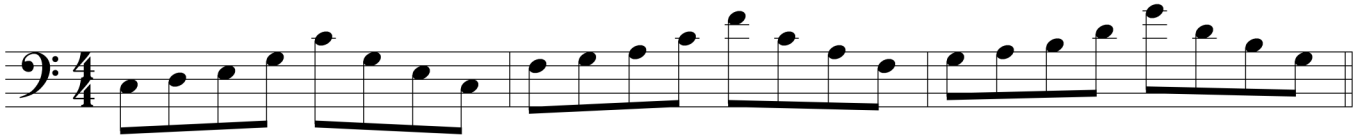
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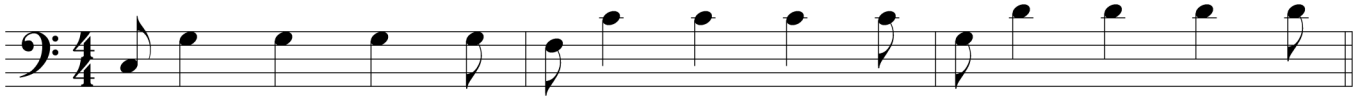
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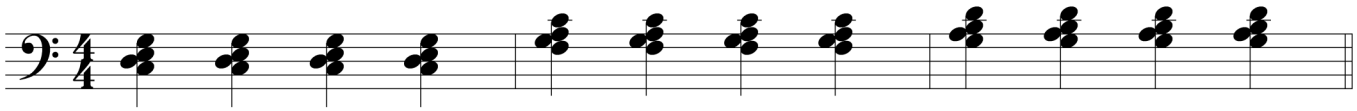
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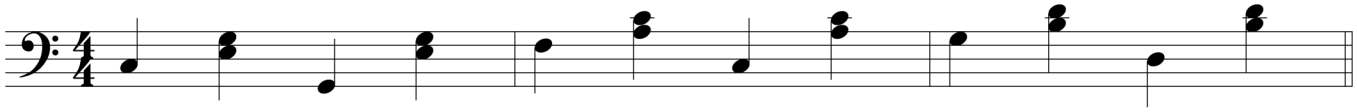
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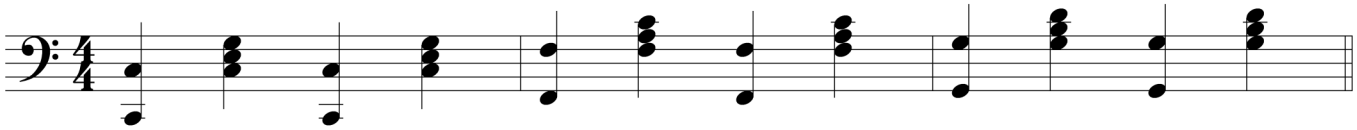
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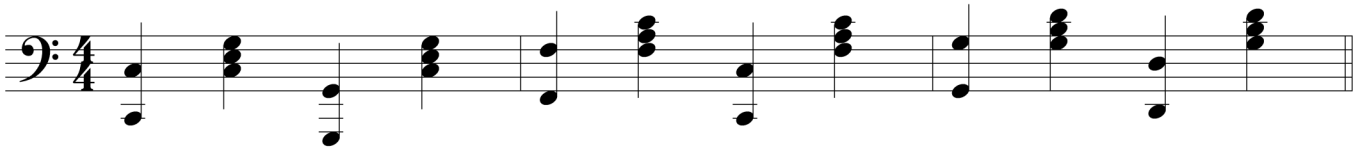
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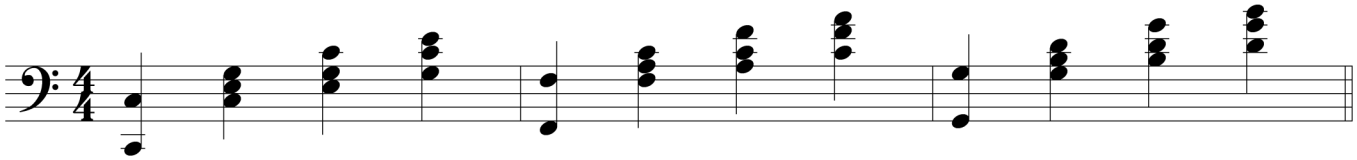
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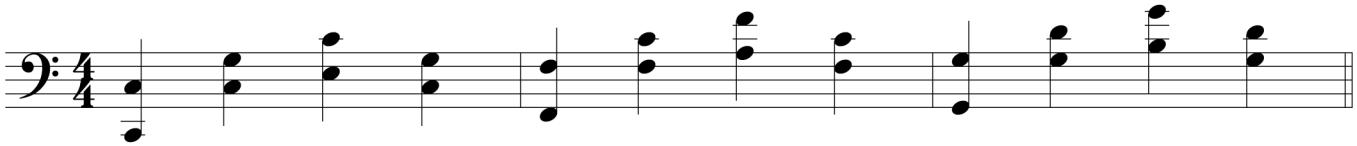
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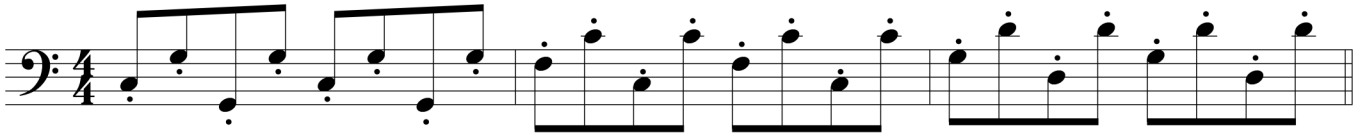
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Left Hand Patterns in $\frac{3}{4}$



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